

RAJENDRA PRASAD N

LEAD AI AZURE DEVOPS ENGINEER | AKS, LLMOps & AI DEVSECOPS

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Lead DevOps Engineer with 10+ years of enterprise cloud, CI/CD, Kubernetes, and production operations experience. Azure-focused platform engineering spanning **AKS, Terraform, Azure DevOps, C#/.NET and Java microservices, REST APIs, and Azure SQL**. Hands-on AI platform delivery covering Milvus and Qdrant administration on AKS, containerized LLM inference, RAG services, GPU capacity, and model observability. Integrates AI DevSecOps, evaluation gates, identity controls, and operational governance into repeatable software and model delivery.

CERTIFICATIONS



GitLab Certified Associate



Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals



Microsoft Certified: Azure DevOps Engineer Expert



AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate



MuleSoft Certified Developer - Level 1

AZURE AI PLATFORM HIGHLIGHTS

- AI Infrastructure** Operate AKS platforms for vector search, LLM inference, and REST-based AI services with repeatable Helm and Terraform deployments.
- LLMOps & Reliability** Connect inference latency, GPU utilization, retrieval quality, and token cost to release gates, capacity planning, and incident response.
- AI DevSecOps** Apply artifact scanning, model provenance, least-privilege access, evaluation checks, and approval controls to AI delivery pipelines.

CORE TECHNOLOGIES

AZURE CLOUD

AKS, ACR, Virtual Networks, Private Endpoints, Entra ID, Workload Identity, Key Vault, Azure Monitor, API Management

DEVOPS & INFRASTRUCTURE

Azure DevOps, Azure Pipelines, GitHub Actions, Terraform, Helm, ArgoCD, Docker, Kubernetes, Linux

AI / LLM OPERATIONS

Azure OpenAI, LLM deployment, vLLM, GPU node pools, RAG, embeddings, model versioning, evaluation gates, Agentic AI

VECTOR DATABASE ADMINISTRATION

Milvus, Qdrant, AKS deployment, persistent storage, sharding, replication, HNSW indexes, snapshots, backup and recovery

APPLICATIONS & DATABASES

C# / .NET, Java, REST APIs, microservices, SQL Server, Azure SQL, MSBuild, Maven, Liquibase

AI OBSERVABILITY & AIOps

Prometheus, Grafana, Azure Monitor, Application Insights, OpenTelemetry, GPU metrics, token usage, SLOs, alert correlation

SECURITY & GOVERNANCE

SAST, SCA, container scanning, secrets scanning, RBAC, network policies, model provenance, prompt-injection checks, audit trails

AUTOMATION

Python, PowerShell, Bash, Azure CLI, YAML, JSON, FastAPI, operational runbooks

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead DevOps Engineer | AT&T Services Inc.

08/2023 - Present

Skills Used: Azure, AKS, Azure DevOps, Terraform, Milvus, Qdrant, vLLM, Azure OpenAI, Prometheus, Grafana, Python

- Engineered Azure AI platform infrastructure with Terraform, provisioning AKS, ACR, private networking, Key Vault, and workload identities for isolated application and model environments.
- Deployed and administered distributed Milvus on AKS using Helm; configured persistent storage, etcd and object-storage dependencies, resource limits, availability controls, and coordinated upgrade and recovery procedures.
- Operated Qdrant clusters on AKS with persistent volumes, shard placement, replication, collection configuration, payload indexes, and HNSW tuning; automated per-node collection snapshots and tested restore procedures.
- Deployed containerized LLM inference services with vLLM on AKS GPU node pools, managing model artifacts, GPU scheduling, readiness probes, request concurrency, and controlled model-version rollouts.
- Tuned inference capacity through GPU memory analysis, batching, queue-depth monitoring, and load testing; balanced latency targets, throughput, and infrastructure cost before production promotion.
- Built Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines for C#/.NET and Java REST microservices, embedding MSBuild/Maven builds, automated tests, image scanning, Helm releases, approvals, and rollback validation.
- Integrated RAG services with Milvus and Qdrant, coordinating embedding-version changes, collection migrations, metadata filtering, retrieval evaluation, and reindexing without mixing incompatible vector dimensions.
- Instrumented LLM and retrieval services with OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Grafana, and Application Insights; tracked time to first token, p95 latency, tokens per second, errors, GPU utilization, and vector-query latency.
- Established model and prompt release gates using versioned evaluation datasets, groundedness and retrieval checks, prompt-injection scenarios, and regression thresholds; retained approval and deployment evidence.
- Applied AI DevSecOps controls through dependency and container scanning, model-artifact provenance checks, restricted egress, Key Vault secrets, workload identity, and namespace-level access controls.
- Governed Azure OpenAI and self-hosted model access through API Management authentication, usage limits, token-cost visibility, and redacted telemetry; documented ownership, retention, and approved model versions.

- Supported Agentic AI services with scoped tool permissions, bounded execution, traceable tool calls, and human approval for sensitive actions; tested failure paths and rollback behavior.
- Developed AIOps workflows that correlated Kubernetes, GPU, database, and inference alerts, enriched incidents with deployment context, and triggered approved recovery runbooks with audit trails.
- Automated SQL Server and Azure SQL release changes with versioned migration scripts, deployment sequencing, connectivity validation, and recovery checks alongside application releases.

Senior DevOps Engineer | [GlobalLogic](#)

03/2023 - 08/2023

Skills Used: Azure DevOps, Azure Pipelines, GitHub Actions, Terraform, Git, PowerShell, Docker

- Built reusable Azure DevOps YAML pipelines for C#/.NET and Java services, integrating build agents, automated tests, artifact feeds, environment approvals, and deployment verification.
- Deployed Docker-based REST microservices to AKS using Helm, managing configuration, secrets, ingress, health probes, and environment-specific release settings.
- Provisioned Azure resources through Terraform modules with reviewed plans, remote state, environment separation, and controlled service connections.
- Coordinated SQL Server and Azure SQL schema changes with application deployments, validating migration order, permissions, and post-release database connectivity.
- Investigated build, container, and Kubernetes failures and strengthened image scanning, branch controls, and documented recovery procedures.

Senior DevOps Engineer II | [Akamai Technologies](#)

12/2021 - 03/2023

Skills Used: AWS, Linode, Python, Terraform, EKS, GitHub Actions, GitLab

- Deployed Kubernetes microservices through ArgoCD-based GitOps workflows.
- Provisioned AWS infrastructure using CloudFormation, Terraform, and pipeline-driven infrastructure-as-code deployment patterns.
- Implemented GitHub Actions workflows for deploying services to Kubernetes clusters across multiple environments.
- Built Docker images and deployed containerized applications to EKS using Helm charts and Kubernetes manifests.
- Implemented disaster recovery, backup, and observability controls using AWS Elastic Disaster Recovery, AWS Backup, and Amazon CloudWatch.

Senior DevOps Engineer / Senior SRE | [Turvo India Pvt Ltd](#)

04/2020 - 12/2021

Skills Used: AWS, Python, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, SonarQube, JFrog, Terraform, Kubernetes, Prometheus, Ansible

- Designed CI/CD pipelines for application and infrastructure deployments across AWS environments.
- Developed internal APIs in Python FastAPI to integrate Jenkins, Jira, and JFrog processes with platform automation.
- Developed custom Prometheus exporters in Python to capture application-specific operational metrics for SRE use cases.
- Built resilient Ansible roles and playbooks to deploy highly available Grafana, Prometheus, and Node Exporter monitoring stacks.
- Authored Helm charts to deploy containerized applications consistently across Kubernetes environments.

Senior DevOps Engineer | [HCL Technologies](#)

02/2019 - 04/2020

Client: Mercedes-Benz Research & Development India

Skills Used: Kubernetes, AWS, Ansible, GitHub, Shell Scripting, Jenkins, Maven, Tomcat, JBoss, Helm

- Designed monitoring architecture to collect application, infrastructure, and platform metrics using the ELK stack.
- Built Kubernetes environments with pods, deployments, services, and ConfigMaps, and managed Helm-based release packaging for multi-namespace workloads.
- Built continuous delivery pipelines and supported REST-based microservices deployments across Demo, Test, Pentest, Training, CTDEV, Sandbox, UAT, and PROD environments.
- Used CloudFormation and PowerShell scripting to provision and manage cloud resources in a repeatable and auditable manner.

DevOps Engineer | [Mphasis Ltd](#)

08/2016 - 12/2018

Client: HPE

Skills Used: AWS, Chef, Ansible, GitLab, Shell Scripting, Python, Maven, Tomcat, JBoss, Splunk, Nexus

- Created deployment pipelines with Ansible to promote releases from development through production in a controlled, repeatable manner.
- Authored and maintained Terraform modules and executed infrastructure changes through automated CI/CD workflows.
- Defined and implemented branching strategies for Git repositories to improve release governance and code promotion.
- Documented build and deployment flows for core infrastructure, API, database, and UI components to improve team consistency.

EDUCATION

B.Tech (2009-2013) in Information Technology

Prakasam Engineering College, Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University, Kakinada